

Make the stories compete

Copy your five carried lines. Then fill the sentences in order. Every blank should point to something you already wrote.

1 · YOUR CARRIED LINES · COPY, DON'T REREAD

Media [promises "one place, seamless"]

Gossip [nobody can tell you where your application is]

History [you can no longer plead your case to a person]

The Break [no way to make a PDF on a phone (8/10)]

Power [it only works because of unpaid helpers]

2 · THE SHARPEST CONTRADICTION

The product claims [to be one seamless place], but [the Villain Story] revealed

[it needs a scanner, a café and a father's phone]

3 · THREE POSSIBLE REDESIGNS · SPECIFIC SCREENS OR STEPS

A [photo-to-PDF inside the upload step] B [an error that says how to fix it] C

[OTP to a number she chooses]

The one that takes the most blame off the user is [A], because

[she no longer needs a scanner or a café]

4 · THE POWER TEST

If this were built, [students without scanners] would gain [a free way to submit].

[Cafés and agents] would resist it, because [they'd lose paid work]

5 · THE FINDING

This product assumes [a scanner and a PDF], but the user actually has

[a phone camera], which causes [a paid trip, a lost day and self-blame]

6 · THE DESIGN CLAIM

We should redesign [the upload step], because it would shift blame from

[the student] to [the portal's missing PDF path], and would specifically help

[students who only have a phone]